

SLI pitch deck

The IBKR permission denial reproduced for me too (fourth consecutive session) — the tape-verification gap stays open and goes in the deck as flagged. Here is the deck, built entirely from the two benches and the evidence pack.

PITCH — SLI — PROPOSED VERDICT (PROPOSED — PENDING ADJUDICATION)

PROPOSED — PENDING ADJUDICATION: NO ENTRY at \$2.37 — stay out; the stock is still absorbing dilution damage while its financing is unresolved. Re-open only on the specific filing triggers below, via a fresh court, not an automatic buy.

What we believe

Standard Lithium (NYSE American: SLI, ~\$2.37, roughly 246.4 million shares outstanding as of August 7, 2026) is a real, advanced lithium project — not a fraud and not a story stock. Its South West Arkansas project, a 55/45 joint venture with Equinor, has a completed definitive feasibility study: US\$1.45 billion of all-in construction cost (that figure already includes a 12.3% contingency cushion), 22,500 tonnes per year of lithium carbonate, and a 20.2% unlevered pre-tax internal rate of return ([feasibility study press release, Oct 14, 2025](#)). The pilot plant's output was just used successfully to make actual battery cells (press release filed with the SEC on August 13, 2026). The lithium price environment supports the project rather than threatening it.

But we believe the stock is currently un-ownable, for one reason: the company slipped its final investment decision, and it is paying for the delay by continuously selling new shares into a depressed market. The day after the second-quarter report that disclosed the slip, the company filed a new US\$50 million at-the-market stock-sale program — while about US\$14 million of the previous program was still unused. It sold roughly \$13.9 million of stock (about 6 million shares) in the five and a half weeks from July 1 to August 7, into a \$2.20–2.50 tape. Last year the same program raised money at an average of \$4.01 per share; today each dollar costs the company nearly twice the shares. Until the project's debt and offtake are actually signed, every week of delay is funded by dilution at bad prices. The damage is not “in the past” — it is arriving continuously.

What the market believes

The market has cut the stock 63% from its 52-week high of \$6.40 and it now sits about 24% above its 52-week low of \$1.91 — so this is not a fresh panic low; some bounce has already happened. The market's implicit view is roughly ours: good project, unfinanced, serial share-seller. The prospectus supplement itself says the project remains “subject to... finalizing additional key contracts and securing suitable project financing” — the market is taking the company at its word that nothing is signed.

Management's more optimistic framing (a target of roughly 80% of production under offtake contracts, and lender "indications of interest") exists only in the earnings call transcript; none of it appears in the vetted SEC documents, and no new offtake agreement has been filed since March 9, 2026. The market is pricing the vetted documents, not the call — and the courts concluded the market is right to.

Why we might have edge

- **We did the balance-sheet arithmetic the headlines don't do.** The bull framing — "\$137 million of cash plus \$64 million of stock-sale capacity comfortably covers the equity check" — double-counts. The \$137.3 million of cash at June 30 is the same cash management has budgeted to burn through June 30, 2027 (about \$36 million per half-year, mostly joint-venture contributions). At a year-end investment decision, free cash is closer to \$100 million. The "comfort" only exists if you pre-spend ~11% dilution through the stock-sale program.
- **We also did the arithmetic in the other direction, which cuts in the company's favor.** Using the feasibility study's true \$1.45 billion all-in cost, an assumed \$1.1 billion of project debt, and \$225 million of committed Equinor-side contributions, the residual equity check is about \$125 million total, of which SLI's 55% share is roughly **\$69 million** — not the ~\$96 million our own red bench first calculated. Against ~\$100 million of free cash, the base case actually covers, thinly (~\$31 million of margin), *without* the stock-sale program. The real risk is fragility: every \$100 million the debt package comes in light adds \$55 million to SLI's check.
- **We measured the dilution in real time.** By comparing remaining stock-sale capacity across two filings five weeks apart, we established the ~\$13.9 million July–early-August sales pace as fact, not inference. That is a measurable tripwire (see reopen conditions), not a vibe.
- **We know exactly what would change the picture:** a signed debt commitment or a second offtake agreement, each of which must arrive as an SEC filing. Those are watchable, binary, and dated.

Why it might be priced in

Symmetry demands we say this plainly: at -63% from the high, the market has already punished the stock for most of what we found. Our central conclusion (good project, dangerous financing gap, continuous seller) is broadly the consensus one. Several things could make staying out wrong:

- The Equinor partnership terms are public and favorable ([Equinor press release, May 8, 2024](#)): \$30 million already paid, a \$60 million funded work program (including a \$33 million carry of SLI's share), and **up to \$70 million more paid to SLI if positive investment decisions are taken**. Our original analysis wrongly called these terms undisclosed. That \$70 million, if it attaches to this project's decision, roughly doubles SLI's cushion and could make the equity check a non-event.
- The lithium price is a tailwind, not a headwind. Our red bench claimed a "six-month slide"; that was wrong. Chinese benchmark lithium carbonate is around ¥148,000/tonne, having *risen* from January to a near-three-year high in May (¥180,000–200,500) before pulling back ~25% over

about three months. A firm price makes both the debt package and offtake economics easier to close.

- The battery-cell validation (August 13 filing) and the feasibility study's built-in contingency mean technical risk is largely retired. If financing closes on schedule, today's price likely never returns.

What we checked ourselves

Claim	How checked	Found	Confirmed?
"~\$201M of resources cover the equity check with headroom" (original thesis)	Read the management discussion & analysis filed with the SEC (filing)	The \$137.3M cash is the same cash budgeted for burn through June 30, 2027; ~\$100M free at decision time; "headroom" = pre-spending ~11% dilution	REFUTED — this framing is struck
Construction cost "\$1.5B base, contingency unquantified" (original thesis)	Read the Oct 2025 feasibility-study press release	US\$1.45B all-in , already including 12.3% contingency; the thesis's caveat was invented. Our red bench then erred too: it found the correct figure but kept using the inflated one, sizing SLI's equity check at ~\$96M; the corrected figure gives ~\$69M — both benches initially ran the check ~40% too high	REFUTED as claimed; corrected math adopted
"Equinor earn-in terms undisclosed/unknowable" (original thesis)	Equinor's own press release	Terms are public: \$30M + \$60M funded work + up to \$70M to SLI on positive investment decisions. Still genuinely unresolved: whether the full \$70M attaches to this project alone (it is an aggregate across two projects)	REFUTED — terms public; one sub-question open
Project financing and ~80% offtake secured or near-secured	SEC prospectus supplement (filing) + full filing inventory	Not secured: "subject to... securing suitable project financing." The 80% target and lender-interest language exist only in the call transcript, not in any vetted document; no offtake filing since March 9. The guided window (fiscal Q3) ends in ~6 weeks	CONFIRMED not secured
Lithium price "recovered" (thesis) vs. "six-month slide" (red bench)	Two independent commodity price sources	~¥148,000/t; rose Jan→May 2026 to a near-3-year high, then ~25% pullback over ~3 months. Red bench error: its "six-month decline" was overturned on the check — it had the trend backwards	Thesis's commodity leg CONFIRMED
Company is a continuous share-seller right now	Diffed remaining stock-sale capacity between the June 30 filing and the August 7 supplement	~\$13.9M sold July 1–Aug 7 (~6M shares into a \$2.20–2.50 tape); lifetime program average \$4.01/share; new \$50M program filed with ~\$14M of the old one unused, one day after the report disclosing the decision slip	CONFIRMED (new finding, missed by the original thesis and by red)
Price anchor (\$6.40 high), bounce, and crowding on the broker tape	Interactive Brokers lookup — permission denied four	52-week figures come from the machine pack; the anchor narrative traces to a secondary source	NOT CONFIRMED — open coverage gap

Claim	How checked	Found	Confirmed?
	consecutive sessions, including this one		
Next earnings date November 5, 2026	Data-vendor derived; no company announcement names it	Unconfirmed	NOT CONFIRMED

PROPOSED ENTRY BANDS

The courts say no entry at any price today, because the blocking finding is a financing binary, not a valuation. No price makes the stock ownable while the debt package is unsigned and the share count is rising weekly — a cheaper entry mostly means the dilution got worse. Accordingly, these are **reopen bands**, not buy orders. Position today: **0% of book, no resting orders**.

Reopen triggers (any one reopens the case for a fresh court; none is an automatic buy):

1. **Signed project-debt commitment of at least US\$1.0 billion, in an SEC filing** (a 6-K — a press release filed through the SEC — not a call transcript). This is the single fact that flips the classification: with debt signed, the ~\$69M equity check is covered by cash on hand with margin, before any Equinor decision payment.
2. **A second offtake agreement filed with the SEC before the end of fiscal Q3 (~September 30, 2026)** — the company’s own guided window. An on-time delivery here would be the first vetted-document evidence supporting management’s more optimistic call commentary.
3. **Confirmation in a vetted document that the \$70M Equinor decision payment attaches to this project’s investment decision.** This alone would double the cushion and could justify reopening even without the debt filing.

Danger-side bands (these harden the no-entry stance rather than reopening it):

- **Price below \$1.91** (a new 52-week low) while the stock-sale program is active: the company would be issuing at ever-worse prices and the equity-check dilution math worsens nonlinearly. If we’re reopened later, a break of \$1.91 first would argue for a smaller starter, not a cheaper bargain.
- **Stock-sale pace above ~\$15 million per month** (measurable from each new filing’s remaining-capacity disclosure vs. the ~\$13.9M/5.5-weeks baseline): the courts set this as the tripwire that the company itself expects financing to slip past year-end.
- **Year-end 2026 passes with no investment decision:** the “funded through June 30, 2027” runway starts to bind and the next raise is likely larger.

Sizing guidance for a future reopened court, from the benches’ math: even in the best reopen scenario this remains a single-project, pre-revenue developer with a binary financing event — the benches’ arithmetic supports at most a starter-size position on trigger 1 or 3, and adds only after an actual investment decision is announced. No trims/exits to specify — there is nothing held.

ARMED SENSORS

(armed provisionally with this deck; session adjudication ratifies)

- price alert: fires below 1.91 (deck-provisional: new 52-week low while the at-the-market share-sale program is actively selling — dilution math worsens)
- filing watch: 6-K until 2027-02-10 (deck-provisional: signed project-debt commitment $\geq$ \$1.0B or a second offtake agreement — the two reopen triggers, valid)
- dated pack SLI|2026-09-30: SLI: fiscal Q3 end — company-guided window for additional offtake agreements (guidance from call transcript, not a vetted filing) (date conf
- dated pack SLI|2026-11-05: SLI: next earnings report (data-vendor derived; no company announcement names it) (date confirmed=False)
- dated pack SLI|2026-12-31: SLI: year-end target for the final investment decision; passing without one starts binding the June-2027 cash runway (date confirmed=False)

What remains unverified

- **The broker tape.** The \$6.40 anchor, the character of the bounce off \$1.91, and any crowding/positioning read rest on the machine pack and a secondary source; four consecutive permission denials mean no bench has confirmed them on live broker data.
- **The November 5, 2026 earnings date** — vendor-derived; no company announcement names it.
- **Whether the \$70M Equinor payment attaches to this project's decision** — the public terms say “up to US\$70 million in aggregate... if a final investment decision is taken,” across two project areas; the split is unresolved and is load-bearing for any future reopen.
- **Everything in the earnings call transcript that isn't in a vetted filing** — the ~80% offtake target and lender “indications of interest” specifically. We treat these as unverified management aspiration until a filing repeats them.
- **The debt package's eventual size** — the ~\$69M equity check assumes \$1.1 billion of project debt; each \$100 million shortfall adds \$55 million to SLI's share, and no committed facility of any size currently exists.

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